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Upliftment of Rural Areas and Tourism

The prime minister's visit was followed by the visits of an unprecedented number of important dignitaries. We had the unique privilege of hosting President Pratibha Devisingh Patil, Vice President Hamid Ansari, Deputy Chairman of Planning Commission Montek Singh Ahluwalia, Speaker of Parliament Meira Kumar, Chief Election Commissioner Navin Chawla, His Holiness the Dalai Lama and some ambassadors, including the British ambassador, Sir Richard Stagg, during my tenure. The president presided over the convocation in the North-East Regional Institute of Science and Technology at Itanagar and visited the border areas of Tawang and Kibithu. She was driven around the Raj Bhawan by me in a small battery-operated car, and was visibly impressed to see the various experiments and initiatives being taken by us, including the essentials of the bamboo project that has now come up in Poma village.

So many high-profile visits had never happened in such a short period in the state's history. These sent out the right message: that the Government of India was doing its best to bring Arunachal at par with the other leading states of our country. Therefore, huge investments were being made in basic infrastructure projects of roads, railways and airports.

Accompanied by Rohini, I have travelled across the length and breadth of this vast state. The aim of these visits was to meet the people of different tribes and get to know their problems, to interact with government officials and observe the state of development and to meet with army, paramilitary and police force officials and get briefed on the security and law and order situation. I consider these